Mahatma Gandhi University, Kottayam-

First Semester MGU-UGP – BSW (Honours) Regular Examination November 2024

Multi-Disciplinary Course - MG1MDCSWK100 – Social Science Perspectives for Social Analysis- QP Code: 24900046

Part A Short Answer Questions Answer any five questions / each question carries 3 marks

1	What is meant by masculinity in sociological terms? In sociological terms, **masculinity** refers to the set of cultural norms, behaviors, roles, and expectations that societies associate with being male or with manhood. These norms are socially constructed, meaning they vary across cultures, historical periods, and individual contexts. Masculinity is not a fixed or biological attribute but rather a dynamic concept shaped by social, economic, and cultural forces. Key Aspects of Masculinity in Sociology: a.Social Construction. b. Hegemonic Masculinity. c Intersectionality d. Gender Performance e Toxic Masculinity f Masculinity in Flux	(K) (2) 2 mark 1 mark
2	Describe ascribed identities and achieved identities? • **Ascribed Identities**: These are identities that individuals are born into or assigned without personal choice. They are typically based on factors such as race, ethnicity, gender, family background, or social class. These identities are determined by societal norms and are often fixed or difficult to change. For example, being born into a specific ethnic group or caste is an ascribed identity. • **Achieved Identities**: These are identities that individuals attain through their own actions, efforts, and choices. They are based on personal accomplishments, skills, or social roles and can change over time. Examples include becoming a doctor, an artist, or an athlete. Achieved identities are shaped by one's ambitions, opportunities, and experiences.	(U) 2 1.5 mark 1.5 mark
3	What is meant by social democracy **Social democracy** is a political and economic system that combines elements of capitalism with strong social welfare policies to promote social justice, equality, and economic stability. It seeks to balance individual freedoms and market competition with government intervention to reduce inequality and provide public goods. **Key Features of Social Democracy:** 1. **Mixed Economy**: 4. **Welfare State** 2. **Democratic Governance** **5. Economic Equality**:. 3. **Labor Rights**	(K) (3) 3 marks
4.	Define Social inclusion **Social inclusion** refers to the process of ensuring that all individuals, regardless of their background, identity, or circumstances, have equal opportunities to participate fully in economic, social, cultural, and political life. It involves removing barriers that exclude people based on factors like poverty, disability, race, gender, or other forms of disadvantage and creating an environment where everyone feels valued, respected, and supported. **Key Aspects of Social Inclusion:** 1. **Access**: Equal access to education, healthcare, employment, and public services. 2. **Participation**: Active involvement in community and societal activities. 3. **Equity**: Addressing systemic inequalities and ensuring fair treatment. 4. **Belonging**: Promoting a sense of acceptance and inclusion in all areas of life.	(K) (3) 3 marks
5.	Importance of objectivity in scientific understanding of society **Objectivity** is vital in the scientific understanding of society as it ensures that research is unbiased, evidence-based, and free from personal or cultural prejudices. This allows sociologists to examine social phenomena accurately and draw reliable conclusions. Here are some key reasons for its importance: 1. Accurate Representation 4. Reliability and Validity: 2. Informed Policy-Making. 5. Reduction of Bias: 3. Scientific Credibility:	(U) (1) 1mark 2 mark
6.	Explain how social stratification can lead to inequality **Social stratification** refers to the hierarchical arrangement of individuals or groups in a society based on factors like wealth, power, prestige, education, or occupation. This structured ranking often results in unequal access to resources, opportunities, and privileges, leading to systemic **inequality**.	(U) (4) 1mark

	They are: 1. **Unequal Distribution of Resources**: 2. **Inherited Disadvantages** 3. **Social Barriers** 4. **Power Imbalances** 5. **Cultural Reinforcement**	2 mark
7.	What are the key principles of Gandhian nonviolence? i. **Ahimsa (Nonviolence)**: Avoid harm in thought, word, and action. ii. **Truth (Satya)**: Pursue truth with honesty and integrity. iii. **Self-Suffering**: Accept personal suffering to resist injustice, rather than inflicting harm on others. iv. **Fearlessness**: Act courageously without hatred or retaliation. v. **Love and Compassion**: Promote understanding and care, even toward opponents. vi. **Faith in Humanity**: Believe in the inherent goodness of people to inspire change.	(U) (5) 3 mark

Part B Essay Questions Answer any two questions / each question carries 10 marks

8	Examine the Role of Education in emplowering Dalit and Adivasi communities in overcoming social barriers. Education plays a critical role in empowering **Dalit** and **Adivasi** communities, helping them overcome social barriers rooted in caste-based discrimination, economic marginalization, and historical exclusion. education contributes to their empowerment: a) **Access to Opportunities**: b) **Breaking the Cycle of Poverty**: c) **Social Awareness and Empowerment**: d) **Reduction of Prejudices and Discrimination**: e) **Political Empowerment**: f) **Cultural Preservation**: g) **Access to Legal and Social Support**: **h) Increased Social Mobility**	(A) (6) 10 marks
9	Explain various social science perspectives on social problems and how they are important in social work interventions Social problems are complex issues that affect individuals, groups, and society as a whole. Different social science perspectives offer varied explanations and solutions to these problems. These perspectives are crucial in guiding **social work interventions**, as they help professionals understand the root causes of problems, design effective interventions, and advocate for social change. Below are the key social science perspectives on social problems and their importance in social work: **1. Structural-Functionalist Perspective:Importance in Social Work**: This perspective helps social workers identify where and how societal institutions (like family, education, or economy) are failing. Interventions may focus on restoring balance or improving the functioning of these structures. For example, addressing poverty by improving the economic system or supporting dysfunctional family structures. **2. Conflict Perspective:Importance in Social Work**: This perspective emphasizes addressing power imbalances and structural inequalities. Social workers advocate for policies and interventions that reduce inequality, such as promoting equal access to resources, fighting discrimination, and supporting marginalized communities in challenging oppressive systems. **3. Symbolic Interactionist Perspective:Importance in Social Work**: Social workers can focus on changing perceptions, attitudes, and behaviors at the individual or group level. Interventions may involve counseling, education, or community-building initiatives that alter the way people view and react to social problems (e.g., substance abuse, mental health issues, or domestic violence). **4. Feminist Perspective:Importance in Social Work**: Feminist social work interventions aim to empower women and gender minorities, address gender-based violence, and promote equal rights. It also involves challenging traditional gender roles and supporting policies that ensure gender equality in various aspects of life. **5. Social Constructionist Perspective:Importance in Social Work**: Social workers can use this perspective to challenge stigmas, shift public narratives, and reframe social issues. For example, changing how society views mental health or homelessness through awareness campaigns or policy	(U) (2 2 mark 8 mark

	advocacy. **6. Human Rights Perspective:Importance in Social Work**: Social workers use a human rights framework to advocate for individuals' rights, promote social justice, and protect vulnerable groups. Interventions may include legal support, policy reform, and grassroots activism to ensure that human rights are respected and upheld. **7. Ecological Perspective:Importance in Social Work**: Social work interventions based on the ecological perspective consider the individual's environment, including family, community, and broader societal factors. It promotes holistic approaches to intervention, such as improving community support systems or advocating for better environmental conditions. **8. Postmodern Perspective:Importance in Social Work**: Social workers with a postmodern perspective value diversity, multiple viewpoints, and individualized solutions. Interventions focus on providing flexible, context-specific support and rejecting one-size-fits-all approaches to solving social problems.	
10	Explain the role of family and education as primary agents of socialization, highlitighting their influence on shaping values, beliefs and behaviours. **Family** and **education** are the primary agents of socialization, playing a critical role in shaping individuals' values, beliefs, and behaviors. These agents influence how individuals learn to navigate and adapt to the social world, and they provide the foundation for the development of personality, identity, and social norms. **Role of Family as an Agent of Socialization:** 1. **Initial Socialization**: 2. **Transmission of Values and Beliefs** 3. **Formation of Identity and Social Roles** 4. **Behavioral Modeling**: 5. **Emotional and Social Support**: . **Role of Education as an Agent of Socialization:** 1. **Knowledge and Skill**: 2. **Social Norms and Values** 3. **Cultural Transmission** 4. **Social Stratification**:. 5. **Peer Socialization** 6. **Role of Teachers and Authority Figures**: **Influence on Shaping Values, Beliefs, and Behaviors:** • **Family's Influence**: Family is the initial context where children learn about love, respect, religion, morality, and gender roles. These early influences often become deeply ingrained, shaping one's worldview and guiding their actions throughout life. • **Education's Influence**: Schools reinforce and challenge the values learned at home, contributing to the broader socialization process. Education plays a key role in shaping attitudes toward equality, justice, democracy, and citizenship, thus preparing individuals to participate in society more effectively..	(K) (1) 1 mark 3 mark 3 mark 3 mark
11	Describe the key difference between assimilation and multiculturalism as approaches to social change. **Key Differences** **Feature** / **Assimilation** / **Multiculturalism** **Focus**: Uniformity and conformity / Diversity and coexistence **Cultural Approach**: Dominance of one culture / Recognition of multiple cultures **Integration**: Minority adapts to majority culture / Mutual respect and shared adaptation **Identity Outcome**: Loss of minority cultural identity / Preservation of cultural identities **Practical Example** • **Assimilation**: Immigrants are required to abandon their native languages and customs in favor of the dominant language and cultural practices of their new country. • **Multiculturalism**: Immigrants are encouraged to celebrate their cultural heritage, while also participating in the broader societal framework, such as through bilingual education and cultural festivals.	(U) (5) 8 mark 2 mark